



THE CONSORTIUM FOR
MATHEMATICS AND
ITS APPLICATIONS

Paper 2614765 Feedback Report

May 07, 2026

Dear Team #2614765,

Congratulations to your team for successfully competing in COMAP's 2026 Interdisciplinary Contest in Modeling (ICM)[®]. Your team chose Problem F in this year's contest. Your team competed against a total of 1,776 international teams. During the triage process, the judges rated your paper as a **Honorable Mention**. Among all the teams competing this year, this above-average result is something to be very proud of.

Honorable Mention - The team's solution report indicated an above average effort in addressing all problem requirements, and contained elements that were judged to show sound and supported processes in modeling and problem solving, analysis, conclusions, and communication of results.

This year we piloted a new process to deliver direct feedback from judges to participating teams. We hope this feedback helps you strengthen your modeling skills and better understand your performance and highlight some areas of improvement.

The judges who reviewed your team's paper identified the following **strength(s)**:

- **Executive Summary:** Your executive summary gives readers a clear and accessible overview of the problem, your modeling approach, and your main results. It allows someone unfamiliar with the details to quickly understand what you did and why it matters.
- **Sensitivity Analysis:** Your sensitivity analysis shows that you thoughtfully examined how changes in your assumptions, inputs, or model structure affect your results. By checking the robustness and flexibility of your model, you demonstrate a strong understanding of how reliable your conclusions are and where the model is most useful.

- **Strengths & Limitations:** Your discussion of the model's strengths and limitations shows thoughtful reflection on your entire modeling process. You clearly connect your comments to specific assumptions, methods, and results, helping readers understand what worked well and why your conclusions are meaningful.
- **Organization & Writing:** Your paper is well-organized and easy to follow. The clear structure and strong writing guide the reader smoothly through your approach, methods, and results, making your work understandable and engaging.
- **Tables & Figures:** Your tables and figures clearly support your analysis by helping readers visualize important patterns and results. You also take the time to explain each visual in the text, making it easy for readers to understand the main takeaways and how the visuals strengthen your argument.

They also noted the following **area(s) for improvement**:

- **Model Implementation:** Your paper would be stronger with a clearer explanation of how you applied your model and how well the results match the model's purpose. Adding more reflection on the limitations or uncertainty in your results would help demonstrate a deeper understanding of what your model can and cannot tell you.
- **Appropriate Explanations:** Your paper would be stronger with more detailed explanations of your modeling decisions. Clarifying not just the steps you took but the reasons behind them, and tying those reasons back to the problem, would help readers follow your process and see the critical thinking behind your choices.

We encourage you to review the UMAP Journal contest editions that will be available on the COMAP website which includes the Director's Article and Judges' Commentary later this year. The articles describes what judges look for in the various sections of solutions, along with exemplars for each section.

We hope that this direct feedback will help you reflect on your modeling work and help you to continue to grow as problem solvers. Thank you for taking the time to participate in this year's ICM contest.

We'd love to highlight your team! If you have a photo or short video from your MCM/ICM experience, please share it with us here: <https://forms.comap.org/260955212277055>

Sincerely,



Amanda Beecher

Director of Contests & Outreach, COMAP